

## Note 2.3 Additional Topics and Applications

### The Adjoint of a Matrix

- **Definition:**

Let  $A$  be a  $n \times n$  matrix. We define a new matrix called the adjoint of  $A$  by

$$\text{adj}A = \begin{pmatrix} A_{11} & A_{21} & \cdots & A_{n1} \\ A_{12} & A_{22} & \cdots & A_{n2} \\ \vdots & & & \\ A_{1n} & A_{2n} & \cdots & A_{nn} \end{pmatrix}$$

- **Properties:**

By [Lemma 2.2.1](#),

$$A(\text{adj}A) = \det(A)I$$

If  $A$  is nonsingular,  $\det(A)$  is a nonzero scalar, then

$$A \left( \frac{1}{\det(A)} \text{adj}A \right) = I$$

Thus,

$$A^{-1} = \frac{1}{\det(A)} \text{adj}A, \det(A) \neq 0$$

### Cramer's Rule

- **Theorem 2.3.1 Cramer's Rule:**

Let  $A$  be an  $n \times n$  nonsingular matrix, and let  $\mathbf{b} \in \mathbb{R}^n$ . Let  $A_i$  be the matrix replacing the  $i$ th column of  $A$  by  $\mathbf{b}$ . If  $\mathbf{x}$  is the unique solution of  $A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b}$ , then

$$x_i = \frac{\det(A_i)}{\det(A)} \quad \text{for } i = 1, 2, \dots, n$$

Proof:

Since

$$\mathbf{x} = A^{-1}\mathbf{b} = \frac{1}{\det(A)} (\text{adj}A)\mathbf{b}$$

then

$$\mathbf{x} = \begin{pmatrix} b_1 A_{11} + b_2 A_{21} + \cdots + b_n A_{n1} \\ b_1 A_{12} + b_2 A_{22} + \cdots + b_n A_{n2} \\ \vdots \\ b_1 A_{1n} + b_2 A_{2n} + \cdots + b_n A_{nn} \end{pmatrix}$$

thus

$$\begin{aligned} x_i &= \frac{b_1 A_{1i} + b_2 A_{2i} + \cdots + b_n A_{ni}}{\det(A)} \\ &= \frac{\det(A_i)}{\det(A)} \end{aligned}$$

Cramer's Rule gives us a method for writing the solution of  $n \times n$  system of linear equations in terms of determinants.

## Application 1 Coded Messages

- **Idea:**

Take a matrix  $A$  whose entries are all integers and whose determinant is 1. (ensure the entries in the  $A^{-1}$  be integers) Then multiply the matrix with coded message by  $A$  to further encode the coded message. Then the message can be decode by multiplying the matrix by  $A^{-1}$ . (The matrix  $A$  can be obtained by apply row operation 1 and 3 to the identity  $I$ ).

## The Cross Product

- **Definition:**

Given two vectors  $\mathbf{x}$  and  $\mathbf{y}$  in  $\mathbb{R}^3$ , then we can define the cross product, denoted  $\mathbf{x} \times \mathbf{y}$ ,

$$\mathbf{x} \times \mathbf{y} = \begin{pmatrix} x_2 y_3 - y_2 x_3 \\ y_1 x_3 - x_1 y_3 \\ x_1 y_2 - y_1 x_2 \end{pmatrix}$$

If  $C$  is any matrix of the form

$$C = \begin{pmatrix} i & x_1 & y_1 \\ j & x_2 & y_2 \\ k & x_3 & y_3 \end{pmatrix}$$

then  $\det(C) = iC_{11} + jC_{21} + kC_{31} = (\mathbf{x} \times \mathbf{y})$  where  $\mathbf{e} = (i, j, k)$ . Then

$$\mathbf{x} \times \mathbf{y} = C_{11}\mathbf{e}_1 + C_{21}\mathbf{e}_2 + C_{31}\mathbf{e}_3 = \begin{pmatrix} C_{11} \\ C_{21} \\ C_{31} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{vmatrix} \mathbf{e}_1 & x_1 & y_1 \\ \mathbf{e}_2 & x_2 & y_2 \\ \mathbf{e}_3 & x_3 & y_3 \end{vmatrix}$$

## Application 2 Newtonian Mechanics

- **Definition of length of vector:**

If  $\mathbf{x}$  is a vector in either  $\mathbb{R}^2$  or  $\mathbb{R}^3$ , then we define the length of  $\mathbf{x}$ , denoted  $\|\mathbf{x}\|$ , by

$$\|\mathbf{x}\| = (\mathbf{x}^T \mathbf{x})^{1/2}$$

and a vector is said to be a unit vector if  $\|\mathbf{x}\| = 1$ .

- **The Representation of a Vector in Two-or-Three-Dimensional Space**

- **In two-dimensional space:**

We can conveniently represent the position of vectors at time  $t$  as linear combination of vectors  $\mathbf{t}$  and  $\mathbf{n}$ , where  $\mathbf{t}$  is a unit vector in the direction of the tangent line to curve at the point  $(x_1(t), x_2(t))$  and  $\mathbf{n}$  is a unit vector in the direction of a normal line to the curve at the given point.

- **In three-dimensional space:**

We define the third unit vector  $\mathbf{b} = \mathbf{t} \times \mathbf{n}$  as the binormal vector which obeys the right hand rule.

## Exercise Section 2.3

- [Question 6th](#)

Property:

If  $A$  is singular, the product  $A \operatorname{adj} A = 0$ .

- [Question 8th](#)

Property:

If  $A$  is a nonsingular  $n \times n$  matrix with  $n > 1$ , then

$$\det(\operatorname{adj} A) = (\det(A))^{n-1}$$

- [Question 10th](#)

Property:

If  $A$  is nonsingular, then  $\operatorname{adj} A$  is nonsingular and

$$(\operatorname{adj} A)^{-1} = \det(A^{-1})A = \operatorname{adj} A^{-1}$$

- [Question 11th](#)

Suppose  $\operatorname{adj} A$  is nonsingular, then there exist  $(\operatorname{adj} A)^{-1}$ . Then

$$A \operatorname{adj} A = \det(A)I = O$$

Then multiply  $\operatorname{adj} A$  of both sides, then

$$A = O$$

But when  $A = O$ ,  $\text{adj } A = O$ , which is singular. That is conflict with the hypothesis.